UNIT 1: BEGINNING YOUR JOURNEY, CAREER READINESS ORIENTATION

TOPIC 2: KNOW YOURSELF

Part 1

Topic OBJECTIVES: The learner will:

- Discover that self-knowledge is a journey
- Understand himself/herself better through experiences, assessments, reflection and feedback
- Identify his/her strengths/positive characteristics

Topic OUTCOMES: The learner will:

- Complete a written I am…
- Complete a series of assessments to understand herself/himself better
- Participate in activities to understand herself/himself better
- Create Positive Identity Circles

Topic ACTIVITIES:

I. Welcome to the Day

Opening Question:

- What are three words you would use to describe your personality?
- What are two of your strengths (or talents or skills)?
- If you could only save three of your belongings, what would you save?

Real-World Application Check-in:

- Ask participants to share observations and thoughts.

II. Pig Personalities Activity (directions included)

- Just for fun — please don't take it too seriously, but think if any of it might apply, if your drawing 'describes' your personality.

III. Quotes and Discussion about Self-Knowledge (some quotes are included)

- Spread a variety of quotes out around the room — hang them on the walls or spread them around on tables/chairs/desks.
- Ask each participant to choose 1 or 2 quotes that they connect with in some way and have them write or draw what the quote means to them. (facilitators should also choose quotes)
- Have all participants share the quote they chose, why they chose it — and ask other people what they think about the quote — what it means to them.
- Listen to the young people — this is a real chance to get a sense of where they are at right now.

IV. Writing: I am...

- Give everyone ten minutes to fill out the writing prompt 'I am…" (Facilitators should participate as well)
- Encourage participants to keep writing, even if they don't know what to write
- Let them know that they do not need to share what they write, but they will have an opportunity to share if they choose to. (As a facilitator, you should be willing to share at least part of what you write as an example)

V. Brainstorming: How do people learn about themselves?

Some ideas:

- Self-reflection
- Feedback from people we trust
- Assessment tools
- Trying new experiences
- Challenging times/good times

After the brainstorm, discuss the different ideas that people generate. If no one has mentioned assessment tools, explain what assessments are and that a variety of assessments will be used in this program to get to know ourselves better.

VI. Assessments

Two assessments that will be completed in this session have to do with personality and skills.

- Personality – Kersey Temperament Sorter http://www.keirsey.com/sorter/register.aspx
  OR
  Jung Test Results – Word Choice Test
  http://similarminds.com/jung_word_pair.html
  OR
  Jung Short Test
  http://similarminds.com/jung.html
- Explore Personality results – print out the detailed description for your type
  http://www.personalitypage.com/high-level.html
- Skills
  Mass CIS SKILLS http://masscis.intocareers.org/skills/skills.aspx
  OR http://www.acinet.org/acinet/Skills/default.aspx
  (scroll down and select start with your skills profile and click on continue)

VII. Activity: Quick Paper Tower Icebreaker

Supplies: copy paper

Directions: Issue a single sheet of paper to each group member (or one sheet per team if the exercise is to be played as a team game). Using the sheet of paper only — no other materials — construct the tallest free-standing structure in 5 minutes.

Points to review:

- Planning and timing — who planned and who ran out of time?
- Pressure — what were the effects on people and performance from the pressure of time?
- Innovation — what innovative ideas were devised?
- Risk — what observations could be made about high-risk and low-risk methods/approaches?
- Learning — would each team/individual be able to improve their result in a second attempt? (Almost certainly.) Discuss how and why, and the value of experience.
- Best practice — if the whole group were to be given the task to build a single tower, what ideas would be combined, and what does this tell us about the power of collective ideas?
- Skills — what skills were found to be crucial for best performance of the task, and could you have guessed what these vital skills would be before the exercise, or did they only become apparent after actually attempting the task? And what does this tell us about the identification of skills (to be developed/taught) for a given task?
- (If played as a team game) What were the opportunities and challenges in enabling the team to perform the task effectively? Consider and suggest a process which would enable an effective team approach to the task: What elements and principles from this are transferable to normal operations and team-working?
- Process improvement — what single tool or additional material (no larger than the width of the paper sheet) would achieve the greatest improvement to the result?
  - *Incidentally, the best technical approach to this task almost certainly requires the construction and use of connectable rolled tubular or triangular telescopic sections made from lengthwise strips of the sheet. Using this technique, it is possible to make a tower at least three times higher than the length of the sheet*
  - *The exercise can be adapted to suit your situation; for example, giving group members 15 minutes for the task and issuing an extra practice sheet of paper will increase the depth and complexity of the task and the review.*

Adapted from: http://www.businessballs.com/freeteambuildingactivities.htm#team-building-games-exercises-activities

VIII. Reflection of the Day (write/share with small group)

- Three new things you learned about yourself today — or three new strengths you realize you have after today's session

Real-World Application: Ask 5-10 people (friends, family members, case worker, teachers, etc) to share 3-5 of the positive characteristics that they see in you.

Pig Personalities

Directions: *Tell participants to draw a pig. Give no further instructions.*
After participants have finished, use the following to 'interpret' their drawings:

- If the pig is drawn on the top of the page, the person is optimistic and positive
- If the pig is drawn in the middle of the page, the person is realistic.
- If the pig is drawn on the bottom of the page, the person might have a hard time seeing the silver linings on the clouds.
- If the pig is facing left, the person is friendly and traditional.
- If the pig is facing right, the person is innovative and action-oriented, but not person or date-oriented.
- If the pig is facing straight ahead, the person is direct and a devil's advocate.
- If the pig is detailed, the person is analytical and cautious.
- If the pig has little detail, the person is emotional and a risk taker.
- If the pig has four feet, the person is secure and stubborn.
- If the pig has less than four feet, the person might be going through a hard time.
- The pig's ear size corresponds with the person's listening skills (the bigger the ears, the better the listener).
- The pig's tail length corresponds with the person's luck in dating/relationships (the longer the tail, the luckier they are).

Adapted from: http://hubpages.com/hub/Pig-Personality-Test

Quotes

1. "Self-knowledge is the beginning of self-improvement."
   ~ *Baltasar Gracián* (Jesuit and writer)

2. "Self-awareness gives you the capacity to learn from your mistakes as well as your successes. It enables you to keep growing."
   ~ *Larry Bossidy* (businessman and author) and *Ram Charan* (business consultant, speaker and writer)

3. "Good leaders learn their specific personal strengths and weaknesses, especially in dealing with other people, then build on the strengths and correct the weaknesses."
   ~ *Larry Bossidy* (businessman and author) and *Ram Charan* (business consultant, speaker and writer)

4. "Everything that irritates us about others can lead us to an understanding of ourselves."
   ~ *Carl Jung* (psychiatrist and founder of analytical psychology)

5. "Self-knowledge is the great power by which we comprehend and control our lives."
   ~ *Vernon Howard* (spiritual teacher, author and philosopher)

6. "You can live a lifetime and, at the end of it, know more about other people than you know about yourself."
   ~ *Beryl Markham* (pioneer aviator)

7. "People often say that this or that person has not yet found himself. But the self is not something one finds, it is something one creates."
   ~ *Thomas Szasz* (psychiatrist and academic)

8. "To the question of your life you are the answer, and to the problems of your life you are the solution."
   ~ *Joe Cordare* (author)

9. "It's a helluva start, being able to recognize what makes you happy."
   ~ *Lucille Ball* (actress, comedian, film and television executive)

10. "There is nothing like returning to a place that remains unchanged to find the ways in which you yourself have altered."
    ~ *Nelson Mandela* (anti-apartheid activist, president of South Africa)

11. "We run away all the time to avoid coming face to face with ourselves."
    ~ *Author Unknown*

12. "Those who are brutally honest are seldom so with themselves."
    ~ *Mignon McLaughlin* (journalist and author)

13. "Let your heart guide you. It whispers, so listen carefully."
    ~ *Littlefoot's mother, Land Before Time*

14. "Your distress about life might mean you have been living for the wrong reason, not that you have no reason for living."
    ~ *Tom O'Connor* (comedian)

15. "Just as we outgrow a pair of trousers, we outgrow acquaintances, libraries, principles, etc., at times before they're worn out and times — and this is the worst of all — before we have new ones."
~ *G.C. Lichtenberg* (scientist, satirist)

16. "You will never come up against a greater adversary than your own potential, my young friend."
~ *Michael Piller* (scriptwriter and producer) and Michael Wagner

17. "If you aren't sure who you are, you might as well work on who you want to be."
~ *Robert Brault* (poet)

18. "The simplest questions are the most profound. Where were you born? Where is your home? Where are you going? What are you doing? Think about these once in a while and watch your answers change."
~ *Richard Bach* (writer)

19. "Quality begins on the inside... and then works its way out."
~ *Bob Moawad* (author)

20. "Be a first rate version of yourself, not a second rate version of someone else."
~ *Judy Garland* (actress and singer)

21. "When you are looking in the mirror, you are looking at the problem. But, remember, you are also looking at the solution."
~ *Anonymous*

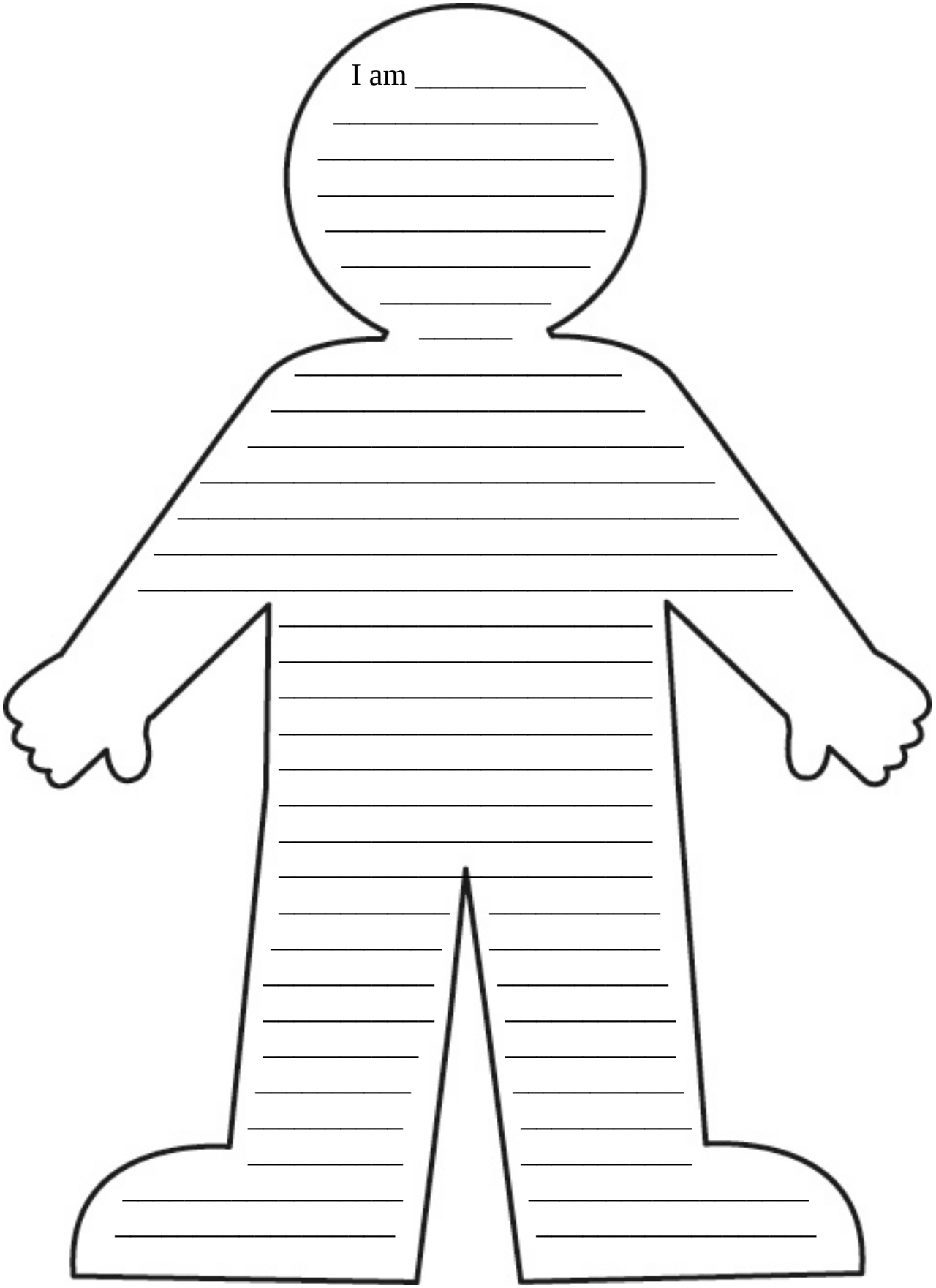
22. "There is no satisfaction that can compare with looking back across the years and finding you've grown in self-control, judgment, generosity, and unselfishness."
~ *Ella Wheeler Wilcox* (author and poet)

23. "You are in control of your life. Don't ever forget that. You are what you are because of the conscious and subconscious choices you have made."
~ *Barbara Hall* (writer and producer)

24. "Until you make peace with who your are... you'll never be content with what you have."
~ *Doris Mortman* (author)

25. "To be nobody but yourself in a world that is doing its best to make you just like everybody else means to fight the greatest battle there is to fight and to never stop fighting."
~ *E. E. Cummings* (poet, painter, essayist, author and playwright)

26. "It was a great surprise to me when I discovered that most of the ugliness I saw in others, was but a reflection of my own nature."
~ *Author Unknown*


I am _____

Part 2

Topic ACTIVITIES:

I. Welcome to the Day

Opening Question:

- Share one of the positive characteristics people often recognize in you (characteristics people you interviewed for homework mentioned)
- Share how it feels when people recognize your positive characteristics

Real-World Application Check-in:

- Ask participants to share observations and thoughts.

II. Assessments

Two assessments will be completed in this session. One is about values and the other one is about multiple intelligences.

- Exploring My Values
- Multiple Intelligence – http://www.bgfl.org/bgfl/custom/resources_ftp/client_ftp/ks3/ict/multiple_int/questions/choose_lang.cfm

III. Activities

1. Card or Color/Shape Challenge

Supplies: deck of cards (for every 3 groups), copies of colored shapes (included — one copy for each group)

Directions:

Note: Groups may not finish this activity, so think in advance how much time you want to spend on this activity.

- Divide participants into groups of 3-4 people.
- Give each group a copy of the colored shapes (or 16 cards from the deck — all four suits of four different numbers or face cards — for example all four jacks, queens, kings and aces).
- Instruct the participants that they need to arrange the shapes or cards into a square (5x5 for the colored shapes, 4x4 for the cards) so that each column and row has only one of each color and shape (or suit and number/face card for the cards).
- After a few minutes, allow one person from each group to walk around to see what the other groups are doing and report back to their group.
- Challenge: *To make it more challenging you can add that the diagonal lines from corner to corner also can only have one of each color/shape or suit/number. This is a good additional challenge for groups that finish while others are still working.*
- Discussion Questions:
  - What did you do first?
  - Did you talk about what you would do or did you just get right to work? Why?
  - Did anyone take a leadership role? In what way?
  - What strategies did your group use? Did you borrow any ideas or strategies from other groups?
  - How did you feel when other groups were watching you? Did you share openly or did you try to hide what you were doing? Why?
  - Did you get frustrated at all during the activity? With the task? With your group? How did you handle it?
  - How do you deal with frustration in other areas of your life?
  - How could the lessons of this activity be applied to a work situation?

2. Copycat

Supplies: No supplies needed

Directions:

- Have everyone choose one person that they are going to copy (you can do this two different ways — have everyone go around and verbally identify the person — or point at the person so everyone is 'copying' a different person in one complete circle OR have everyone choose someone in their head and keep it to him/herself).
- Tell them when the game begins (when you say go) they can not move unless the person they are watching moves and then they need to copy exactly what that person does.
- Play for about five minutes.
- Discussion questions:
  - Who moved first?
  - Did you ever move — not copying someone?
  - Was there any point when everyone was doing the same thing?
  - How did it feel to copy someone's every move?
  - Did you ever lose focus and realize you were not copying the person's every move?
  - How did it feel to have someone copying you?
  - If people did not identify who they were copying, was anyone able to identify person(s) copying him/her?
  - Do you see yourself as a leader? Where do you lead people? How do you lead people?
  - When do you find yourself following someone else? Is it bad to follow people? When might it be smart to follow someone else?

IV. Writing/Reflection

Positive Identity Circles

Supplies: Identity Circle handout, pens/pencils

Directions:

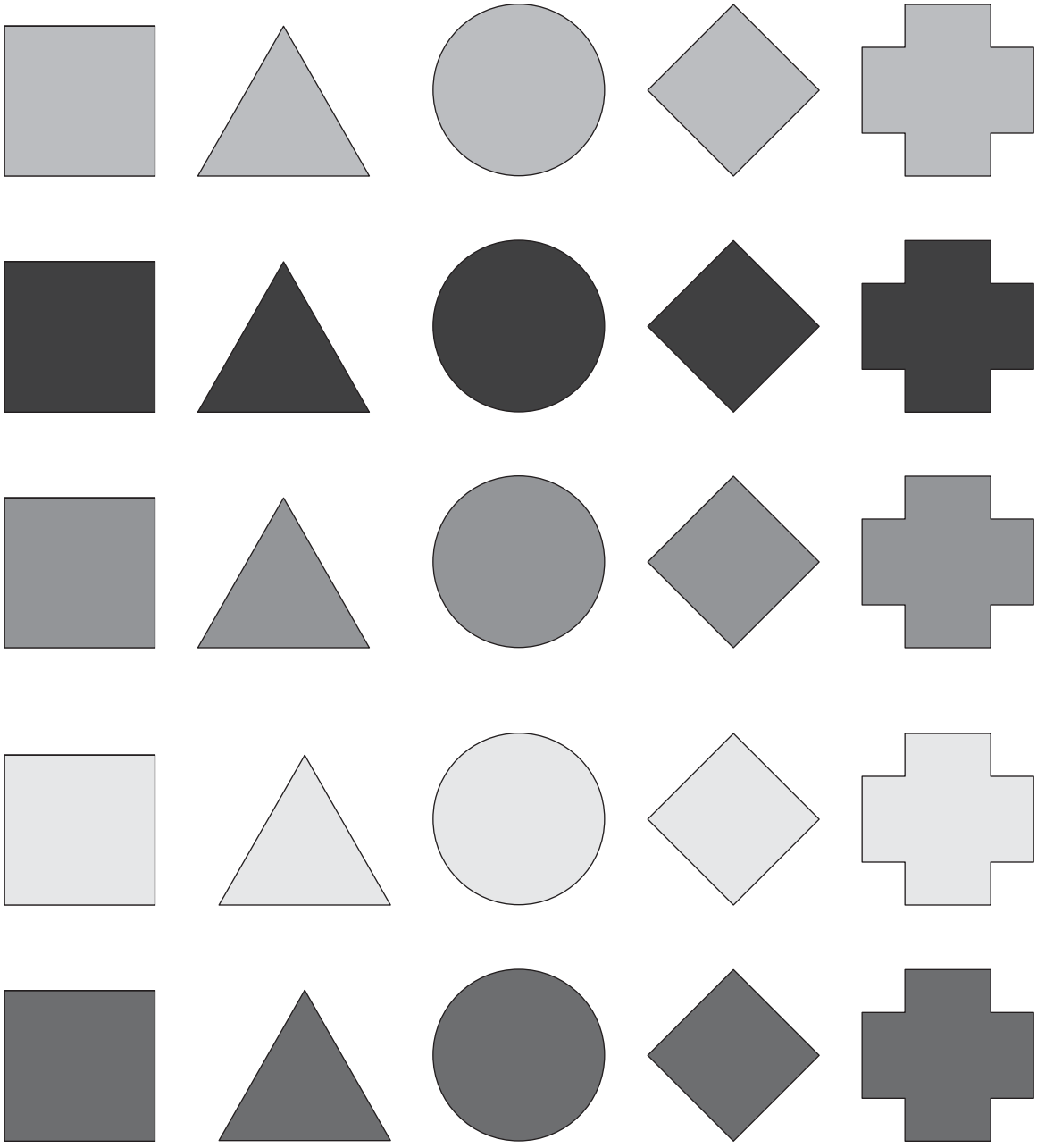
- Identify at least eight positive aspects of you to write/draw in your identity circles. These could include:
  - Strengths
  - Personality characteristics
  - Values
  - Intelligences
  - Personal qualities
- Create your Positive Identity Circles
- Share your Positive Identity Circles

V. Reading Activity

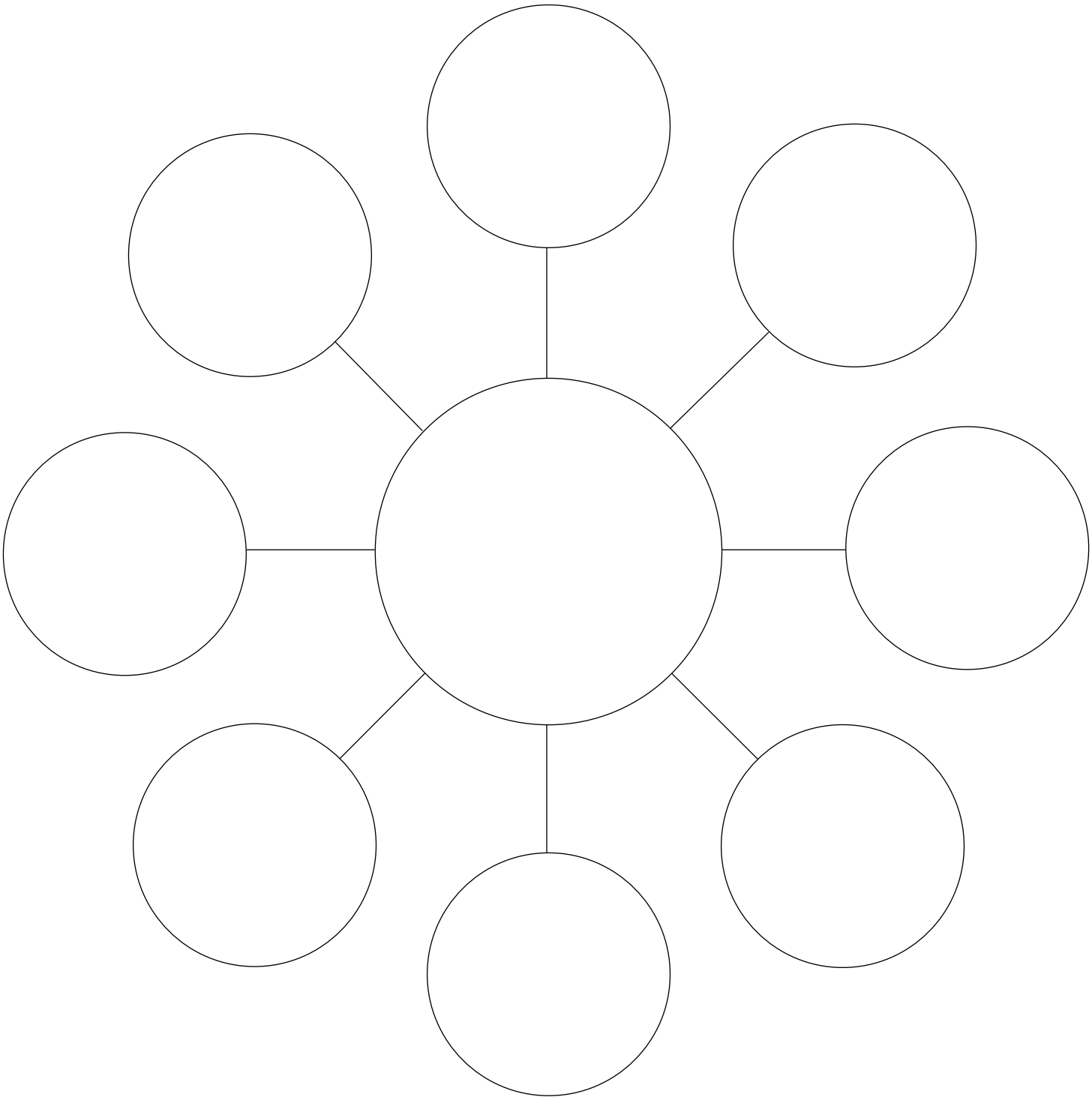
- Read and discuss *Seeds of Greatness* and/or *When I was Young*

Real-World Application: Be aware of when you demonstrate the positive characteristics, aspects of you that you wrote in your Positive Identity circles — how does it feel to be that way?

Color Shape Activity



Positive Identity Circles



Seeds of Greatness Leadership Activity

By *Denis Waitley*

- We must feel love inside ourselves before we can give it to others.
- Our minds can't tell the difference between real experience and one that is vividly and repeatedly imagined.
- Our rewards in life will depend on the quality and amount of the contribution we make.
- A large vocabulary — which implies broad, general knowledge — characterizes the more successful persons.
- The reason so many individuals fail to achieve their goals in life is that they never really set them in the first place.
- A touch is worth a thousand words.
- Life is a self fulfilling prophecy; you won't necessarily get what you want in life, but in the long run you will usually get what you expect.
- The good old days are here and now.
- Winners work at doing things the majority of the population are not willing to do.
- How we see life makes all the difference.

http://www.asbdirector.com/leadership/seeds.html retrieved March 16, 2010

When I Was Young Leadership Story

The following words were written on the tomb of an Anglican Bishop in the Crypts of Westminster Abbey:

> "When I was young and free and my imagination had no limits, I dreamed of changing the world. As I grew older and wiser, I discovered the world would not change, so I shortened my sights somewhat and decided to change only my country. But it, too, seemed immovable. As I grow into my twilight years, in one last desperate attempt, I settled for changing only my family, those closest to me, but alas, they would have none of it. And now as I lay on my deathbed, I suddenly realize: If I had only changed myself first, then by example I would have changed my family. From their inspirations and encouragement, I would then have been able to better my country and, who knows, I may have even changed the world."
> ~ *Anonymous*

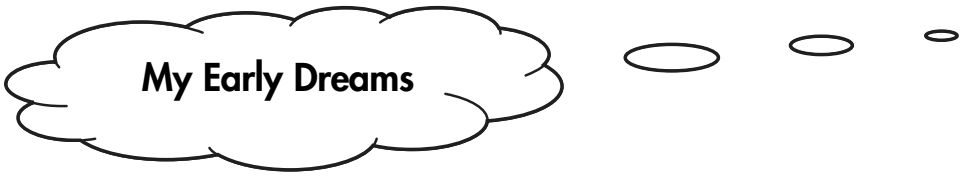
http://www.asbdirector.com/leadership/young.html retrieved March 16, 2010

Exploring My Values

What makes people show up for work everyday? One obvious answer is — a paycheck. But money isn't all that people want from work. In fact, research shows that most people think some things are more important than money. People who like their work — and there really are millions of them! — usually, rate pay as the # 8 value in a list of 10. Some things people might value more than money are recognition for doing a good job, working as part of a team, building something people need, or helping people improve their lives.

What would make you show up for work everyday? Once you have a regular paycheck, you'll want satisfying work to keep you coming back. The aim of this lesson is to discover your work values — the things you want to get from work to feel it's worth the effort. When your work fits with your values, work isn't just a way to pay the bills; it's fulfilling and exciting.

Once you identify which values are most important, think about the kinds of work that would provide them. That's an important step in making career decisions that will be right for you.



As children, most people have dreams about what they want to be when they grow up. What jobs sounded good to you when you were a child? As you get older, you may no longer want that dream, or may feel that it is unrealistic, but you may still want some of the values those dreams represent. Complete the following activities.

1. When I was younger, I wanted to be a _____.
2. In the list below, "My Values," circle the values, or reasons, why you wanted that job/career.
3. Look at the list again. Write below five (5) values that are most important to you **today**. Have your values changed?

_____ _____ _____

_____ _____

My Values:

Achievement	Cooperation	High Income
Respect	Advancement	Creativity
Honesty	Security	Ambition
Influence	Service	Artistry
Knowledge	Status	Entrepreneur
Independence	Leadership	Team Work
Beauty	Excitement	Loyalty
Time freedom	Physical activity	Known as an expert
Trust	Challenge	Fame
Wealth	Change and variety	Fast pace
Power	Competence	Freedom
Predictability	Work alone	Competition
Friendship	Privacy	Contribution
Helpful	Recognition	Wisdom

Budgeting My Values

Our choices in any situation reflect our values. This activity gives you a chance to see how your values affect your choices in spending. Below is a survey to help you determine what your values are. It's fun, and you may learn some surprising things about yourself!

Directions: *Imagine that you have $10,000.00 and a list of possible items to spend it on. Read the list of items carefully. In the space to the right of each item, decide how much of your $10,000.00 you would pay for that item. Allocate money only to those items you really want to have. The more important the item is to you, the more money you should budget for it. You can spend $500.00 on one item, and $100.00 on another. You can spend no money on items that don't appeal to you at all, and you can spend your entire $10,000.00 on one item if that's what you want to do. Spend all of your $10,000.00 — you can't take it with you. If you find you have overspent, go back and change the amounts until it equals $10,000.00. Do the same if you have not spent all your money.*

Remember that your choices will reflect the values that are most important in your life at this time. Five years ago they might have been different. Five years from now they probably will be different, reflecting your movement and growth over time.

Items to Buy	Amount Spent
1. A chance to rid the world of prejudice	_____
2. A chance to serve the sick and needy	_____
3. A guarantee to become a famous person (movie/music star, sports hero, astronaut, etc.)	_____
4. An idea that will bring you money and fame	_____
5. Perfect understanding of the meaning of life	_____
6. A vaccine to make all persons incapable of theft or lying	_____
7. A chance to set your own working conditions	_____
8. To own stock in a highly successful company	_____
9. The Presidency of the United States	_____
10. The perfect love affair	_____
11. A house with a beautiful view, with your favorite works of art	_____
12. To be the most attractive person in the world	_____
13. To live to one hundred with no illness	_____
14. The most complete library of great books for your own private use.	_____
15. Harmony with God, doing God's work	_____
16. A way to rid the world of unfairness	_____
17. The resources to donate one million dollars to your favorite charity	_____
18. To be voted outstanding person of the year and praised in every newspaper	_____
19. To master the profession of your choice	_____
20. Time with nothing to do but enjoy yourself, with all needs and desires automatically met	_____
21. To be the wisest person in the world	_____
22. A scheme to sneak "truth serum" into the drinking water	_____
23. A way to do your own thing, without hassles	_____
24. A large room full of silver dollars	_____
25. The love and admiration of the whole world	_____
26. Peace of mind	_____
27. Your own powerful computer, for any and all facts you might need	_____

Key

Below is a definition for each value in this activity. Check it after you have allocated your money.

1 & 16	Justice	The quality of being impartial or fair
2 & 17	Humanitarianism	Regard for the interests of others
3 & 18	Recognition	Being made to feel significant and important
4 & 19	Achievement	Accomplishing goals
5 & 21	Wisdom	Insight, good sense, judgment
6 & 22	Honesty	Straightforwardness, integrity
7& 23	Autonomy	Able to be independent
8 & 24	Material wealth	Abundance of material possessions
9	Power	Authority or influence over others
10 & 25	Love	Affection, attachment to others
11	Aesthetics	The appreciation and enjoyment of beauty
12	Physical attractiveness	Concern for the appearance of one's body
13	Health, physical well-being	Concern for the health of one's body
26	Emotional well-being	Freedom from overwhelming anxieties
20	Pleasure	Satisfaction or gratification
14 & 27	Knowledge	The seeking of truth and/or information
15	Religious faith	Communion with and action in behalf of a Supreme Being

For which 3 items did you budget the most money? What is the value from the list above?

	Top 3 Items	**The Value**
1.	_____	_____
2.	_____	_____
3.	_____	_____

Look at the values you selected in "My Early Dreams" and in this activity. What do you consider your top 3 values? That is, what are the 3 things you'd like to get from work?

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

List 3 realistic careers that would be compatible with your current values:

_____ _____ _____